

# TRAN LE

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## EDUCATION AND HONORS

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**Cornell University**, College of Arts & Sciences, Ithaca, NY

**Aug 2023–May 2027**

B.A., Psychology & Information Science; *Concentrations in Cognition & User Experience*

**Cumulative GPA:** 4.219/4.3

**Academic Awards:** Foreign Students Scholarship • Sugita Family Scholarship • S. H. Baik Family Scholarship

**Relevant Coursework:** Human-Computer Interaction (A) • Statistics & Research Design (A) • Empirical Research (A+) • Data Science (A+) • Communication and Technology (A+) • Digital Product Design • Information Ethics, Law, and Policy (A) • Human Perception: Application to Computer Graphics, Art, and Visual Display (A+)

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Communication and Collaborative Technologies Lab**, Ithaca, NY, *Research Assistant*

**Feb 2025–present**

- Develop [XPLAIN](#), a proactive real-time AI communication support tool designed to reduce comprehension barriers and participation gaps for non-native English speakers in video conferencing.
- Plan and conduct 15 in-person Wizard-of-Oz usability testing studies, including drafting test plans, study protocols, and data collection materials (consent forms, screening instruments, surveys, interview questions).
- Coordinate participant recruitment and study logistics, including recruiting via SONA, scheduling sessions, booking lab testing rooms, and managing multi-device experimental setups across sessions.
- Support IRB submissions and participant-facing documentation; guide participants through consent, pre-study surveys, live interaction tasks (as a confederate), post-study surveys, and semi-structured interviews.
- Code behavioral data (e.g., disfluencies, gaze, interaction); conduct thematic interview analysis in [ATLAS.ti](#); analyze and visualize survey and qualitative data in R to identify usability issues and performance tradeoffs.

**Research Project with Weill Cornell Medicine**, Ithaca, NY, *Research Assistant*

**Jul–Dec 2025**

- Transcribed speech from dysphonic patients using Praat to create ground-truth data for auditing and fine-tuning commercial automatic speech recognition (ASR) systems that underperform on medically impaired speech.

**Cornell Phonetics Lab**, Ithaca, NY, *Research Assistant*

**Aug–Dec 2024**

- Reviewed ASR-generated transcripts and produced ground-truth linguistic and conversational data in Praat.
- Analyzed and visualized data in R to examine phonetic, lexical, and conversational patterns.

## PROJECTS

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[Cross-Cultural Healthcare Communication](#), *Computing & Global Development (A+)*

**Aug–Dec 2025**

- Interviewed 13 international students, healthcare providers, and translators-interpreters to identify communication gaps, limitations of current technological tools, and design opportunities for better support in U.S. healthcare.
- Analyzed qualitative interview data using structured activity notes and thematic clustering.
- Authored research reports documenting methods and translating qualitative findings into actionable recommendations for inclusive healthcare communication technologies and institutional practices.

[Reposet](#), *Human-Computer Interaction (A)*

**Aug–Dec 2025**

- Planned and conducted contextual interviews and field research, preparing interview protocols, consent materials, and contextual inquiry guides to uncover user pain points and guide persona creation and problem statement.
- Analyzed interview data using affinity diagramming to translate observed user needs, habits, and behaviors into product features for a context-aware wardrobe system supporting low-effort outfit planning, clothing rotation, wardrobe visibility, and motivated sustainable reuse.
- Planned and ran usability testing and heuristic evaluations, analyzing think-aloud feedback and task breakdowns to refine user interface design, features, and interaction flows.
- Documented and justified methods, findings, design decisions, and design tradeoffs in written deliverables.
- Presented a poster and a showcase video demonstrating the app's design, interaction flow, and usage scenarios.

[Duolingo Note-Taking Case Study](#), *Digital Product Design*

**Feb–May 2025**

- Conducted user interviews with Duolingo learners to identify learning retention and active recall challenges.
- Synthesized interview findings and competitive analysis of other language learning apps to identify opportunity areas for designing an in-app note-taking feature in Duolingo.

## TOOLS & EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

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**Tools:** R, ATLAS.ti, Qualtrics, Python, Figma, JavaScript, React, Node, Express, Mongo, HTML, CSS, Trello

**Extracurricular activities:** Women in Computing at Cornell (Faculty Relations Director) • Cornell Undergraduate Research Board (Peer Mentor) • Psi Chi (Member) • Translator Interpreter Program (Volunteer)